

Final Report on

YOUTH RIGHTS TO PARTICIPATE AND PROTECTION FROM HIV/AIDS



Supported by
The Mercury Phoenix Trust
United Kingdom

Organized by
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PREAMBLE

The project titled "YOUTH RIGHTS TO PARTICIPATE AND PROTECTION FROM HIV/AIDS" was supported by The Mercury Phoenix Trust, U.K, and implemented by Chaitanya Kala Bharathi, Nandyal, in the colleges and technical institutions spread in 7 mandals of Kurnool District.

OBJECTIVES OF THE PROJECT

The organization set the following as the objectives of the project to meet the set outcomes:

- Rights of Target Young People to Protect themselves against HIV/AIDS and STDS
- To have access to Youth Friendly Services.
- To Contribute to the National Goal of reducing the increasing trends of prevalence of HIV and incidence



PLANNED INTERVENTIONS

In tune to achieving the set objectives, CKB has prepared a plan of action to take up the interventions.

- ⇒ Organize sensitization camps to adolescent girls, college youth, in target villages to raise the levels of awareness on Reproductive Tract Infections (RTI) and Sexually Transmitted Diseases (STDs) including HIV/AIDS in the rural and slum areas and for the welfare of vulnerable groups as well as the general public.
- ⇒ Conduct Survey and identify HIV/AIDS affected / afflicted persons (PLAs) and provide Escort services to HIV/AIDS affected / afflicted through the Programme Volunteers for Counseling, Treatment with ARV Drugs, Rehabilitation at the available Centres.
- ⇒ Conduct community awareness camps, specifically on knowledge, attitude and practice of High-Risk Groups.
- ⇒ Prepare, Print and Distribute Resource Material on Prevention and Control of AIDS Resource materials like Posters, Pamphlets etc., to the target groups and general public.
- ⇒ Organize Rallies and Kalajasthas to educate the target groups and general Public.

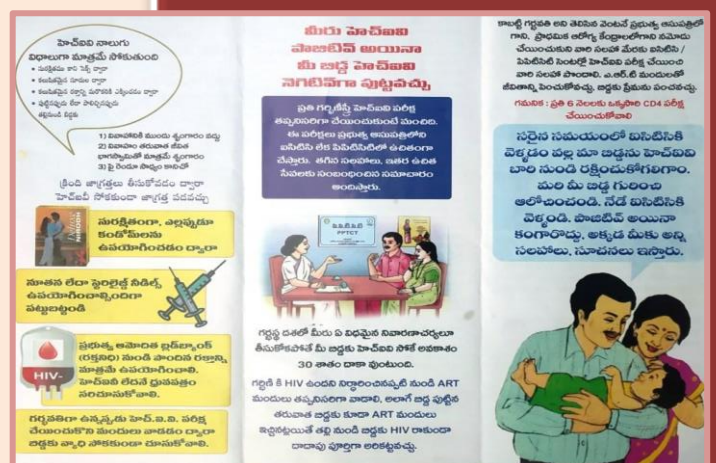


PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION

It was planned to organize the activities in various educational institutions, viz., schools, colleges, and Industrial Training Institutes (ITI) in Kurnool District.

As a part of this, the organization has initiated the basic preparatory activities, which included –

Printing of Literature: Literature on HIV/AIDS with full details was prepared in local Telugu language with the support of



persons working in the health department, i.e., doctors and other literary specialists.

Adequate number of Pamphlets, Booklets and Posters have been printed and kept ready for distribution during the campaign.

ENGAGING CULTURAL TEAMS: Professional cultural teams have been identified for performing cultural shows in the planned venues. The theme of the project is explained to them. They practiced the theme and prepared skits, songs and mono actions for the same.

RESOURCE PERSONS: The organization identified qualified resource persons who are connected to Medical department, and are involved in counseling activities. The resource persons were engaged basing on their availability in the respective places where the programmes were organized.

- 1) Dr. Mallikarjuna Reddy, MBBS and Civil Surgeon, PHC, Kowluru
- 2) Dr. Manohar, M.B.B.S., (Rtd.) Deputy Para Medical Officer, Panyam
- 3) Dr. K. Sreenivasa Rao, M.B.B.S., MD, Professor in Micro-Biology, Kurnool Medical College,
- 4) Dr. S. Haricharan, M.B.B.S., M.S. (Anesthesia), Kurnool Govt. Gen. Hospital.
- 5) Dr. Sreenivasulu, Civil Surgeon, PHC, Bandi Atmakur.
- 6) Dr. Smt. Mythrayi, MBBS, DGO, PHC, Velgode
- 7) Mrs. K. Anuradha, Executive Officer, Panyam
- 8) Dr. K. Murali Krishna, Rtd., Principal, Govt. Junior College, Atmakur
- 9) Mrs. Sudha Rani¹, District Project Manager, Nestham, Kurnool
- 10) Mr. Naresh, Project Coordinator, HIV/AIDS Project, Kurnool
- 11) Mr. S. Venkatanarayana, Principal, Junior College, Velgode.

¹ She is an HIV Positive woman. Her daughter is also infected with HIV. She attributed this from her husband, who was an AIDS patient who hid this information before getting married to Sudha Rani.



- 12) Dr. N. Rambhupal Reddy, Principal, SNSR Degree College, Velgode
- 13) Mr. M. Venkataramana, NSS Programme Office, Junior College, Velgode
- 14) Mr. N.Ch. Vasudeva Gupta, MPDO, Bandi Atmakur.
- 15) Mr. Zulfiquar Ali Khan, Programme Manager, MERIBA (AIDS Project), Atmakur.

DETAILS OF AWARENESS MEETINGS ORGANIZED:

Chaitanya Kala Bharathi, has conducted 10 meetings targeting a total 2000 teenagers.

- ⇒ Meeting at Panyam: The first meeting was conducted in Panyam village, which is also the mandal headquarters town. The meeting was organized Gram Panchayath office with the support of the Grampanchayath. The meeting was attended by a total of 62 Volunteers coming from 5 nearby villages.
- ⇒ Meetings at Kurnool: In Kurnool town, two meetings were organized. The first one was in Sarvodaya ITI which was attended by about 80 youth, and the second meeting organized in Krishnaveni ITI was attended by about 52 youth.
- ⇒ Meeting at Kodumur: In Kodumur town, a meeting was organized in Adi ITI, which was attended by 81 youth.
- ⇒ Meeting at Velgode: In Velgode town, 3 meetings were organized. The first meeting was organized at SNSR Degree College, and it was attended by 112 youth and women; the second meeting was organized at Velgode Junior College, and was attended by 79 youth and women; and the third meeting was organized at Sardar Patel ITI, which was attended by a total of 42 youth of both sexes.



- ⇒ Meeting at Nandyal: A meeting was organized at Tarakarama D.Ed., College, and it was attended by 68 women/ adolescent girls.
- ⇒ Meeting at Bandi Atmakur: The meeting organized in the MPDO office premises was attended by 58 Volunteers coming from 9 surrounding villages.
- ⇒ Meeting at Banaganapalli: This meeting organized at Pendekanti Venkata Subbaiah ITI was attended by 61 youth coming from the nearby 8 villages.



THE CONTENT OF THE MEETINGS:

These participants were explained about various aspects of HIV/AIDS and its spread. The preventive aspects, and information related to other STD and in association with the prevalence of TB among the HIV/AIDS patients was explained. The participants were also explained about the process of testing for diagnosis of HIV / AIDS, and the process of counseling etc.



Focused attention was paid to educate them with regard to the trauma faced by these patients, and the process of approaching them, and counseling them so that their morale is boosted.

Other very specific aspect that was dealt was regarding the welfare of their families – which is referred to be as the 'affected family'. The

RIGHTS OF PERSONS LIVING WITH HIV/AIDS:

During all these meetings, and trainings, the organization has taken special care to explain the participants about the Legal Provisions in Indian Laws with regard to the Rights of persons living with HIV / AIDS. A brief note of the same is given hereunder:



- Article 14 guarantees the right of equality of treatment to the HIV/AIDS patients.
- Articles 15 and 16 protect them against discrimination.
- Article 21 of the Constitution protects their right to life and personal liberty and ensures their right to privacy.
- The Directive Principles of State Policy also cast a duty upon the States to ensure right to livelihood and prevent discrimination.
- Article 39 of the Constitution directs the States to ensure that all the citizens including the HIV/AIDS patients have an adequate mean of livelihood.
- Article 42 casts a duty upon states to make provisions for securing just and humane conditions of work. States have been entrusted with the duty to improve public health vide Article 47 of the Constitution.

Along with this, the Legal Provisions in Indian Medical Council Act, 1956 (Professional Conduct, & Ethics) Regulations, 2002 has layed down certain duties that have to be observed by the doctors towards the HIV/AIDS patients. They include:

- Duty to take care and to take informed consent from the patient.
- Disclosure of information & risks to the patient
- Provide information of options available & benefits
- Duty to warn
- To admit patient in emergency without consent
- The physician should not abandon his duty for fear of contracting the disease himself.



The above information is carefully explained to the participants so that when they are in their duty of meeting, counselling, and can explain them in their traumatic conditions about the right to access medical support to ensure that they can make a life, leaving behind the fear of their vulnerability.

TRAINING TO 10 ADOLESCENT PEER EDUCATORS:

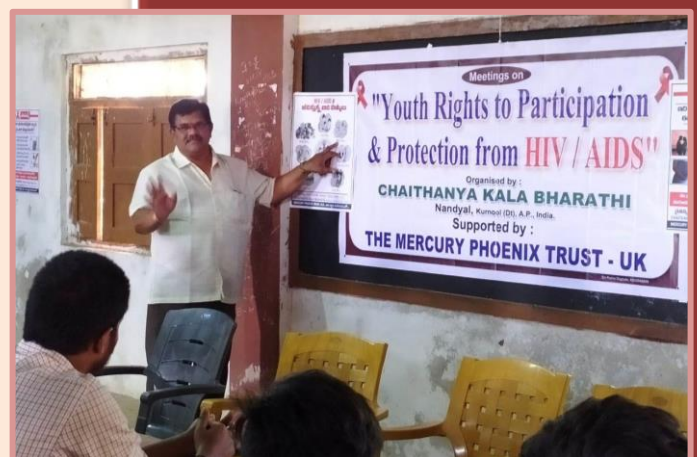
As a part of the programme, CKB has organized a 3-day training programme for 10 selected peer educators. This programme was organized in Adoni Town.

The major focus of the training was related to the debacle of HIV / AIDS, its spread and the consequences. The training focused on the slogan of 'Be Bold' which is being introduced by the Indian Medical Department, to promote the people to come up and speak about HIV/AIDS without feeling delicacy of speaking about sex related issues in public – which is the major cultural drawback in India.

The participants were explained about the inheritance of HIV from one person to another person through means of sexual intercourse, blood transfusion etc. Information on misconception about the spread of HIV/AIDS through touching each other, sitting together, having food with HIV/AIDS affected people etc., were explained with suitable examples.

Focused attention was also paid in the preventive aspects, adhering to loyalty with the life partners, to be away from illegal / unfair sexual contacts with unknown persons, to adopt sex control; to be confident about life and future.

Demos were performed, using artificial dildo, with regard to use of condoms as a part of prevention of HIV infection in case of circumstances unavoidable when they come in contact with unknown partner(s).



The process of HIV / AIDS testing; stages of HIV and its turning into AIDS, treatment; the impact of nutritious food in the recovery of the infected person, the regular usage of medicines, their availability in the local government hospitals and in certain centres exclusively setup for the treatment of HIV / AIDS – which are called as ART Centres were explained to them.

The DOs and DON'Ts in the personal life with regard to sexual aspects, preventive aspects were explained with demonstrations etc.

CULTURAL EVENTS:

Chaitanya Kala Bharathi has engaged the services of professional cultural teams for performing the cultural shows in Junior Colleges, Degree Colleges, Industrial Training Centres (ITIs); and Teacher Training Centres (D.Ed. College). A total of 10 shows were organized. The teams enacted the theme of HIV /AIDS and its spreading, prevention aspects in the form of songs, skits and mono-actions. These shows were attended not only by the students, but also by the several general publics during the performance.

Video shows, on HIV/AIDS, which are in Telugu language are projected. The titles of these shows are “Deerghayushman Bhava” (Long you live); “Manalo Okadu” (One among us); “Ashraddhatho Anardham – Tappatadugu – Diddubatu” (Negligence and Impact – A mistake and Corection); “Hero Avvandi” (Become a Hero) are the video shows that have been projected during the cultural shows.



INTERACTIVE SESSIONS

During the programmes the organization has distributed the printed literature to all the participants. In addition, the professional medical doctors have spared time to respond to the questions of the participants with regard to several health problems with regard to STDs (Sexually Transmitted Diseases) along with treatment for HIV / AIDS. Information with regard to taking nutritious food which includes more protein contents was advised by the experts for the HIV infected people. The need to be calm and composed and not get excited or depressed about any health or other problems is advised.



IMPACT

- ⇒ As proposed in the original project proposal, the project imparted informative knowledge to the youth on the aspects of HIV/AIDS – what it means, how it spread, the preventive aspects, and allied information through meetings, cultural shows and trainings.
- ⇒ The knowledge of discretion to reject unfair, unwanted and unsafe sex has been imparted to the youth people so that they not only safeguard themselves against the possibility of acquiring STDs including HIV/AIDS, but also can advise and guide their fellow villagers / youth in protecting themselves against such havocs.
- ⇒ Information with regard to the Rights of the persons affected and infected with HIV / AIDS has been shared, which will be shared with the concerned. This will help the people in traumatic conditions to access medical facilities, livelihoods through demanding employment as their Rights without being frustrated of their social and economic status.



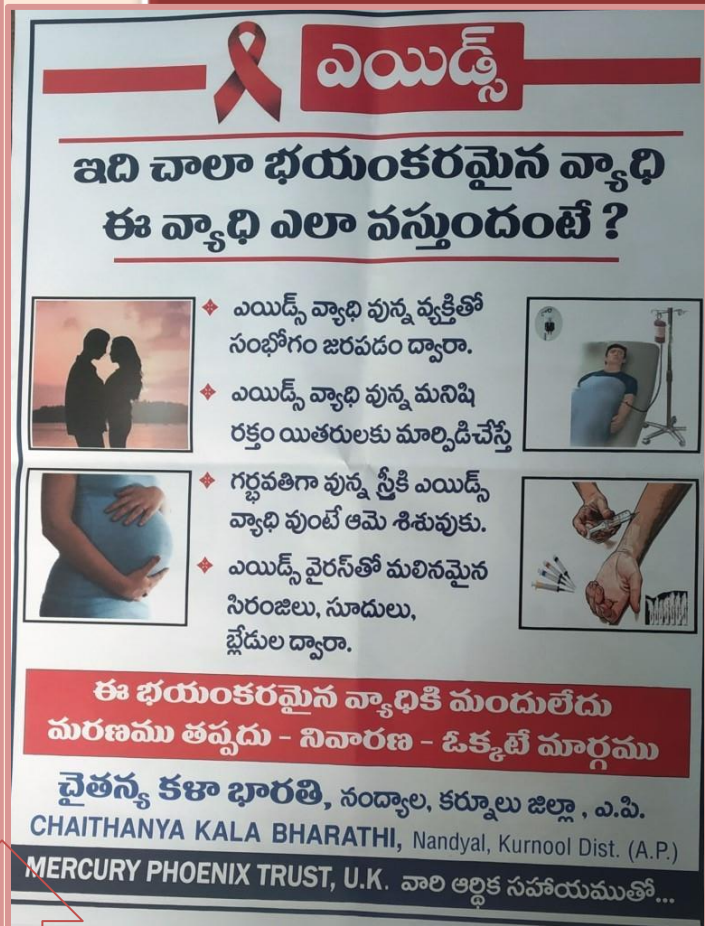
- ⇒ The youth have now got the knowledge and are empowered to work together as groups so that they can spread the information into the society for its long term well-being.

OUR THANKS

Chaitanya Kala Bharathi, would like to take this opportunity to thank The Mercury Phoenix, UK for extending their support to organize this very useful programme for the benefit of the youth in getting cautious toward safeguarding against HIV/AIDS.

We also take this opportunity to thank all the institutional Heads, and the Youth who have participated in these programmes and turned them into success.





The 2 Posters were designed and printed for pasting on the walls in the institutions & villages



